

Chandan Bhattarai
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Department of Agricultural Economics
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Education

Ph.D. Agricultural Economics – **Kansas State University**, Manhattan, KS Aug 2023- May 2027
Advisor: Dr. Jesse Tack
Dissertation Title: “Essays on Risk Management in Agriculture: Insurance Rating, Contract Incentives, and Investment Decisions”

M.S. Agricultural Economics – **University of Arkansas**, Fayetteville, AR Aug 2021-Aug 2023
Advisor: Dr. Andrew McKenzie
Thesis Title: “Risk Return of Forward Contracting Southern Row Crops with Crop Revenue Insurance”

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant Jan 2025 – May 2025
KSU: Agricultural Economics, Manhattan, KS
AGEC 120: Introduction to Agricultural Economics and Agribusiness

- Responsibilities: Proctoring Exam, obtaining solutions for examinations, grading, and answering 90-100 students’ questions

Graduate Teaching Assistant Aug 2021 – Dec 2021
UofA: Agricultural Economics, Fayetteville, AR
AGEC 3413: Principles of Environmental Economics

- Taught class lectures in the absence of the instructor (90 students in the spring)
- Responsibilities: Proctoring Exam, obtaining solutions for examinations, grading, answering students’ questions, and helping 80-90 students to prepare for exams

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant Aug 2023 – Present
KSU: Agricultural Economics, Manhattan, KS

- Conducted econometric analysis of farm-level data (KFMA) to evaluate risk management and farm investment decisions.
- Collaborated with folks from the Rural & Farm Finance Policy Analysis Center (RAFF) at the University of Missouri to project the 2025 and 2026 ARC PLC payments for different crops under OBBA.
- Developed theoretical and empirical models examining moral hazard in forward contracting under crop insurance.
- Integrated multi-source datasets (crop trials, weather, and insurance data) for panel analysis of yield risk across Kansas.

Graduate Research Assistant Aug 2021 – Aug 2023
UofA: Agricultural Economics, Fayetteville, AR

- Quantified how crop insurance participation affects producers’ forward-contracting decisions for corn, rice, and soybeans using econometric analysis and simulation.

- Built and analyzed multi-year datasets (USDA-NASS yields/prices, RMA base rates) for five Arkansas counties to evaluate risk–return trade-offs and non-delivery exposure.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Journal Articles (*Published*)

1. **Bhattarai, C.**, McKenzie, A., Biram, H., Durand-Morat, A., & Tack, J. (2026). Risk>Returns of Forward Contracting Corn with Crop Insurance. *Journal of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association*.
2. Bhandari, S., Jha, D. K., Shrestha, A., Sapkota, B., **Bhattarai, C.**, Rijal, S., & Pokhrel, S. (2021). Determinants of gross income from carp production in Bara district, Nepal. *Journal of Agriculture and Natural Resources*, 4(2), 124-133.
3. Bhandari, D., **Bhattarai, C.**, Dahal, B. R., Gautam, A., & Joshi, P. P. (2021). Determinants of Rice Seed Replacement Rate (SRR) in Kanchanpur District, Nepal. *Nepalese Journal of Agricultural Sciences*, 21(20), 59-69.
4. **Bhattarai, C.**, Bhandari, D., Bhandari, S., Bhusal, K., Khatri, B., Srivastava, A., & Sapkota, B. K. (2020). Factors Affecting Coffee Productivity in Gulmi and Arghakhanchi Districts of Nepal. *Journal of Agriculture and Natural Resources*, 3(1), 51-60.

Extension Articles

1. Pongspikul, T., Paudel, A., **Bhattarai, C.**, Wongpiyabovorn, O., Ifft, J., & Plastina, A. (2025, November). Projected 2025 and 2026 ARC-CO and PLC payments for soybeans (RaFF Policy Brief No. 2025-11(3)). Rural and Farm Finance Policy Analysis Center, University of Missouri. <https://raff.missouri.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/11/2025-11-3-RaFF-Policy-Brief.pdf>
2. Pongspikul, T., Paudel, A., **Bhattarai, C.**, Wongpiyabovorn, O., Ifft, J., & Plastina, A. (2025, November). Projected 2025 and 2026 ARC-CO and PLC payments for corn (RaFF Policy Brief No. 2025-11(2)). Rural and Farm Finance Policy Analysis Center, University of Missouri. <https://raff.missouri.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/11/2025-11-2-RaFF-Policy-Brief.pdf>
3. Ifft, J., Joseph, D., Paudel, A., & **Bhattarai, C.** (2025, October). *Projected ARC, PLC, and crop insurance net payouts per acre under OBBBA*. (K-State Department of Agricultural Economics Extension Publication). Kansas State University. <https://agmanager.info/crop-insurance/crop-insurance-papers-and-information/projected-arc-plc-and-crop-insurance-net>
4. Pongspikul, T., Paudel, A., **Bhattarai, C.**, Wongpiyabovorn, O., Ifft, J., and Plastina, A. (2025, October) “*Projected 2025 and 2026 ARC-CO and PLC Payments for Wheat*.” RaFF Policy Brief 2025- 10(4), Rural and Farm Finance Policy Analysis Center, University of Missouri-Columbia. <https://raff.missouri.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/10/2025-10-4-Policy-Brief.pdf>
5. **Bhattarai, C.**, Ifft, J., Paudel, A., & Joseph, D. (2025, September). *Estimated net returns to Supplemental Coverage Option participation before and after OBBBA changes* (K-State Department of Agricultural Economics Extension Publication). Kansas State University. <https://www.agmanager.info/crop-insurance/crop-insurance-papers-and-information/estimated-net-returns-supplemental-coverage>
6. **Bhattarai, C.**, Ifft, J., Paudel, A., & Joseph, D. (2025, September). *SCO Expected Net Indemnity Payments Map* (K-State Department of Agricultural Economics Extension Publication). Kansas State University. <https://agmanager.info/crop-insurance/crop-insurance-papers-and-information/sco-expected-net-indemnity-payments-map>
7. Ifft, J., Joseph, D., Paudel, A., **Bhattarai, C.**, & Moss, L. (2025, July). *Mapping the Farm Safety Net: County Average Commodity Payments and Crop Insurance Net Indemnities, 2014–2023* (K-State Department of Agricultural Economics Extension Publication). Kansas State University. <https://www.agmanager.info/crop-insurance/crop-insurance-papers-and-information/mapping-farm-safety-net-county-average>
8. Biram, H., McKenzie, A. M., & **Bhattarai, C.** (2025, June 11). *How can crop marketing and crop insurance go together?* *Southern Ag Today*, 5(24.3). <https://southernagtoday.org/2025/06/11/how-can-crop-marketing-and-crop-insurance-go-together/>

Work in Progress

1. Pongspikul, T., Paudel, A., Bhattarai, C., Wongpiyabovorn, O., Ifft, J., & Plastina, A. (R&R). Expanded farm safety net payments under the One Big Beautiful Bill Act. *Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy*.
2. Measuring Kansas Farmers' Risk Preferences Using Farm Level Data (with Jesse Tack)
3. Risk Premiums of Previous Crop in Winter Wheat and their Implications for Insurance Rating (with Jesse Tack and Romulo Lollato)
4. AgriBot: Improving Farmer Access to Extension Publications Through AI-Assisted Summaries (with Jennifer Ifft and Nirmal Gelal)

Presentation

1. **Bhattarai, C.**, & Tack, J. (2026). Measuring Kansas farmers' risk preferences using KFMA data. **Oral**. *SCC-76 Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO*; March 22-24, 2026
2. **Bhattarai, C.**, McKenzie, A. M., Biram, H. D., & Durand-Morat, A. (2023). Risk>Returns of Forward Contracting Southern Row Crops with Crop Revenue Insurance. **Oral**, *Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting*, Washington, DC; July 23-25, 2023
3. Khatri, B., Pokharel, S., & **Bhattarai, C.** (2018), Economic Analysis of Fish Marketing in Nawalparasi District of Nepal, **Poster**, *International Agricultural Marketing Conference on Marketing and Value Chain Development in Agriculture and Food System*, Kathmandu, Nepal, June 4-5

Service, Memberships, and Awards

Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Member	Mar 2023 – Present
KSU Alumni Scholarship Award, KSU	Apr 2025
Student Opportunity Award, Kansas State Foundation	Apr 2024
International Student Center Scholarship, International Student & Scholar Services, KSU	Apr 2024